

BIOIA / WUOM

47 • THE CHROMATIC TRANSITION

WHAT GREEN ARE WE MAINTAINING?



THE CHROMATIC TRANSITION

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GREEN IS NOT TERRITORY

The word **green** can refer to many different things.

It can refer to:

- a technology;
- an energy source;
- a public policy;
- an institutional label;
- a promise of transition.

But none of these is, by itself, equivalent to territory.

Green is not territory.

COLOR DOES NOT DEFINE THE ARCHITECTURE

A system can change color without changing its foundation.

It can incorporate:



renewables



wind energy



electrification



emissions reduction

while, at the same time, keeping intact the logic from which it decides:

- **where to intervene;**
- **how much to deploy;**
- **what surface to use;**
- **what impacts to assume;**
- **who absorbs the territorial burden.**

That is why it is useful to distinguish from the outset:

COLOR

from

ARCHITECTURE

Color describes an appearance, a purpose or a category.

Architecture describes the order from which a system classifies, prioritizes and distributes its action across the territory.

TWO DIFFERENT GREENS

There is a **system green**:

- objectives
- policies
- technologies
- indicators
- communication

And there is a **territory green**:

- 🌱 living soil
- 🌳 trees
- 💧 water
- 🐞 biodiversity
- 🌾 agricultural capacity
- 🌿 ecological balance

Both can coincide.

But they do not coincide automatically.

The transition begins to become problematic when the first green expands by weakening the second.

THE PROBLEM IS NOT GREEN

The problem is not that an infrastructure is presented as green.

The problem appears when the adjective **green** replaces the material question:

what new relationship does this transition establish with the territory?

Because an intervention can be:

- renewable in energy terms;
- institutionally prioritized;
- discursively sustainable;

and still reproduce an architecture in which territory appears primarily as **available surface**.

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

The transition does not become structural when the technology changes.

It becomes structural when the order governing the relationship between:

territory · need · technology · decision

changes.

If that order does not change, we may be facing a chromatic transition:

the color of the system changes, but the way the system uses the territory does not necessarily change.

PAGE CLOSING

Green can be a technical solution.

Territory is not a color.

are we transforming the architecture or merely painting it green?

THE ORDER MATTERS

A transition can introduce new technologies while keeping intact the order from which decisions are made.

That creates a fundamental difference.

It is not the same to ask:

Where can we place what the system needs?

as to ask:

What can this territory sustain, and what energy response is compatible with that capacity?

Both questions may lead to renewable infrastructure.

But they begin from different architectures.

ORDER OF DEPLOYMENT

One possible logic starts from above:

 **system**



 **technical capacity**



 **human need**



 **territory**

The objective has already been defined.

Then the system looks for where to materialize it.

In this architecture, territory can end up appearing mainly as:

 **location**

 **surface**

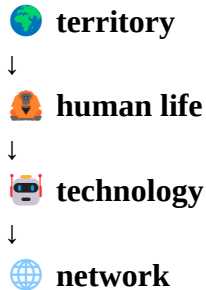
 **potential**

 **grid connection capacity**

The territory receives the solution.

ORDER OF MATERIAL DEPENDENCE

But our actual dependence works in the opposite direction:



Without soil, water, biodiversity, climate stability and material capacity:

the human layer that sustains technology and the network does not exist.

A structural transition should therefore incorporate this order of dependence into its decision architecture.

THIS IS NOT ABOUT MECHANICALLY REVERSING THE CHAIN

Starting from territory does not mean that each municipality should decide its entire energy system in isolation.

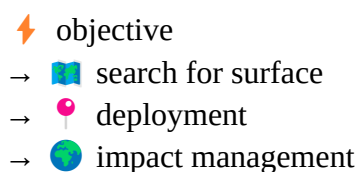
Nor does it mean preventing infrastructure at a supra-local scale.

It means something more precise:

territorial capacity must be part of the definition of the solution, not appear only as a later constraint.

TWO ARCHITECTURES

A · DEFINED NEED → TERRITORY OF DEPLOYMENT



versus:

B • TERRITORIAL CAPACITY → COMPATIBLE RESPONSE

 limits and capacities

→  classification

→  need

→  technology

→  deployment

The difference is not necessarily whether renewables are used.

It lies in:

when territory enters the decision.

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

If territory enters only at the end to absorb, compensate for or correct impacts, the architecture can remain essentially unchanged even if the technology is green.

If territory enters at the beginning as a material condition of the decision, something deeper begins to change:

the very definition of what is possible.

PAGE CLOSING

A structural transition does not only ask where the solution fits.

It first asks:

what solution fits within the territory without undermining what that territory depends on?

CHROMATIC TRANSITION

CHANGES APPEARANCE.
THE ORDER REMAINS.

WHAT CHANGES

-  COLOR
-  TECHNOLOGY
-  LABELS
-  DISCOURSE

WHAT REMAINS

-  CLASSIFICATION
-  CONCENTRATION
-  DECISION
ARCHITECTURE
-  TERRITORY AS
SURFACE

VS.

STRUCTURAL TRANSITION

CHANGES THE ORDER.
TRANSFORMS THE TERRITORY.

WHAT CHANGES

-  TERRITORIAL
CLASSIFICATION
-  SCALE
-  DISTRIBUTION
-  DECISION
-  TERRITORIAL
RETURN

WHAT IS TRANSFORMED

-  TERRITORIAL
CLASSIFICATION
-  SCALE
-  DISTRIBUTION
-  DISTRIBUTED
DECISION
-  TERRITORIAL
RETURN

NOT EVERY GREEN TRANSITION
CHANGES THE ARCHITECTURE.



THE TRANSITION BEGINS
WHEN THE ORDER CHANGES,
NOT JUST THE COLOR.

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CHROMATIC TRANSITION VS STRUCTURAL TRANSITION

PLATER AS A TEST CASE

PLATER allows us to move the question of Document 47 from the conceptual level to a concrete territorial case.

Not to decide in advance whether the plan is right or wrong.

But to observe **what happens when an energy transition encounters territorial information that questions its mode of deployment.**

THE TRANSITION ALREADY HAS AN OBJECTIVE

The starting point is not in dispute:

- ☀️ **increase renewable generation**
- 🔌 **reduce fossil dependence**
- ⚡ **transform the energy system**

The question comes afterwards:

how is that objective translated onto the territory?

Because the same climate objective can be materialized through different territorial architectures.

THE TERRITORY RESPONDS

The PLATER process has produced a significant territorial response:

- 🏛️ **municipalities**
- 🌾 **agricultural organizations**
- 🌿 **environmental organizations**
- 🌀 **territorial platforms**
- 👤 **citizens**

Coverage of the 10 August press conference places the conflict at a broad scale:

308 municipalities
more than 11,800 objections

The discussion is no longer limited to:

how many megawatts do we need?

It also includes:

where?
how?
with what degree of concentration?
on what land?
with what territorial effects?
who participates in defining the solution?

ADJUST OR TRANSFORM

The institutional response introduces a decisive word:

ADJUST

Territorial contributions may allow the plan to be adjusted to the reality of each municipality.

But the question does not end there.

Because there are at least two possibilities:

OBJECTIONS

↓

change locations

↓

correct surfaces

↓

modify some parameters

→ **ADJUSTMENT**

or:

OBJECTIONS

↓

modify criteria

↓

reorganize priorities

↓

alter distribution and concentration

↓

change the relationship between energy and territory

→ **STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATION**

They are not equivalent.

HERE · VISIBLE, BUT NOT OPERATIONAL · REAPPEARS

We asked:

at what point did the signal stop moving forward?

Now we can ask another question:

what happens when the territorial signal does enter the procedure?

TERRITORIAL EVIDENCE

→ **CLASSIFICATION**

→ **PRIORITY**

→ **DECISION**

→ **MATERIAL MODIFICATION**

The existence of participation does not by itself prove that there is return.

Return is verified by what actually changes.

BIOIA HYPOTHESIS

The number of objections measures participation.

It does not yet measure transformation.

The material test will come when we can compare:

initial PLATER

↓

resulting PLATER

and answer:

- which criteria changed;
- which territory ceased to be considered available;
- which concentrations were modified;
- which territorial knowledge altered a decision;
- and which elements remained unchanged.

PAGE CLOSING

Listening to the territory is one condition.

Modifying the architecture on the basis of what has been heard is another.

The PLATER question is:

will the objections change the map, or will they also change the logic that produces the map?

PLATER is Catalonia's Territorial Sectoral Plan for Wind and Solar Photovoltaic Electricity Generation, the planning framework used to define where and under what criteria these renewable-energy infrastructures may be deployed.

In this document, **PLATER** is used as an open territorial test case, not as a predetermined example of failure.

DOCUMENTO 47

47 • THE CHROMATIC TRANSITION

GREEN IS NOT TERRITORY.

INVERTED ORDER

The system starts from the logic of the network and ends up placing the burden on the territory.



ORDER OF MATERIAL DEPENDENCE

The territory sustains life. Life sustains technology. Technology must serve the network.



THE TRANSITION BEGINS
WHEN THE ORDER CHANGES,
NOT JUST THE COLOR.

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THE TRANSITION BEGINS WHEN THE ORDER CHANGES • NOT JUST THE COLOR.

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